

Ride-Along Field Note — Maria R., Tuesday Shift

Day 3 · FieldPulse Research Packet. Raw observation notes from one shift shadowing **Maria R., Lead Dispatcher, Reliable Climate Co. (90 technicians, 12 years dispatching).** Observed behavior only — no interpretation. Use as Observed-tier evidence when building your persona canvas.

Observer: Product researcher, FieldPulse Dispatcher Workflow squad **Setting:** Branch dispatch desk, two monitors + desk phone + a personal paper notebook

Timeline

- **06:40** — Arrives 20 min before first dispatch. Opens FieldPulse dashboard *and* a spiral notebook. Copies today's truck-stock numbers from the app into the notebook by hand before doing anything else.
 - **06:55** — First re-route: a tech calls out sick. Maria reassigns 6 jobs in ~9 minutes, flipping between the map view and a **paper map taped beside the monitor**. Does not use the app's in-tool routing suggestion.
 - **09:20** — Mid-morning re-route (customer no-show). Visibly tenses; says under her breath "here we go." Reassigns from memory, then updates the app after the fact.
 - **11:30** — Asked (unprompted) why the notebook: "The inventory screen is *three clicks deep* and I need it in two seconds when a tech's standing on a roof. Faster to keep my own." Continues using the notebook as source of truth for truck stock all day.
 - **12:15** — Two techs message asking "does dispatch know where my truck is?" Maria answers both by phone, not in-app.
 - **14:45** — Second sick-call re-route of the day. Third re-route event overall.
 - **17:05** — Shift "ends." Maria stays at the desk.
 - **17:05–17:52** — **Post-shift reconcile.** Retypes the day's paper tickets into the system, cross-checks the notebook truck-stock against the app, resolves two mismatches by hand, submits the day. **47 minutes.**
 - **17:52** — Leaves. Comments: "That's a normal night."
-

Observed behaviors (count-tagged)

- Maintains a **parallel paper record** (notebook) for truck stock because the in-app inventory view is 3 clicks deep — used all shift.
- Keeps a **paper map** beside the monitor; ignores the app's routing suggestion during re-routes.
- **Three re-route events** in one shift; each visibly raised stress; app updated *after* the decision, not during.
- **47-minute post-shift reconcile** re-typing paper tickets and reconciling stock before she can leave.
- Answers "where's my truck" tech questions **by phone**, not through the app.